

Holy Words of Christ and the Inner Spiritual Conflict: A Symbolic Interpretation of Matthew 10:35–37

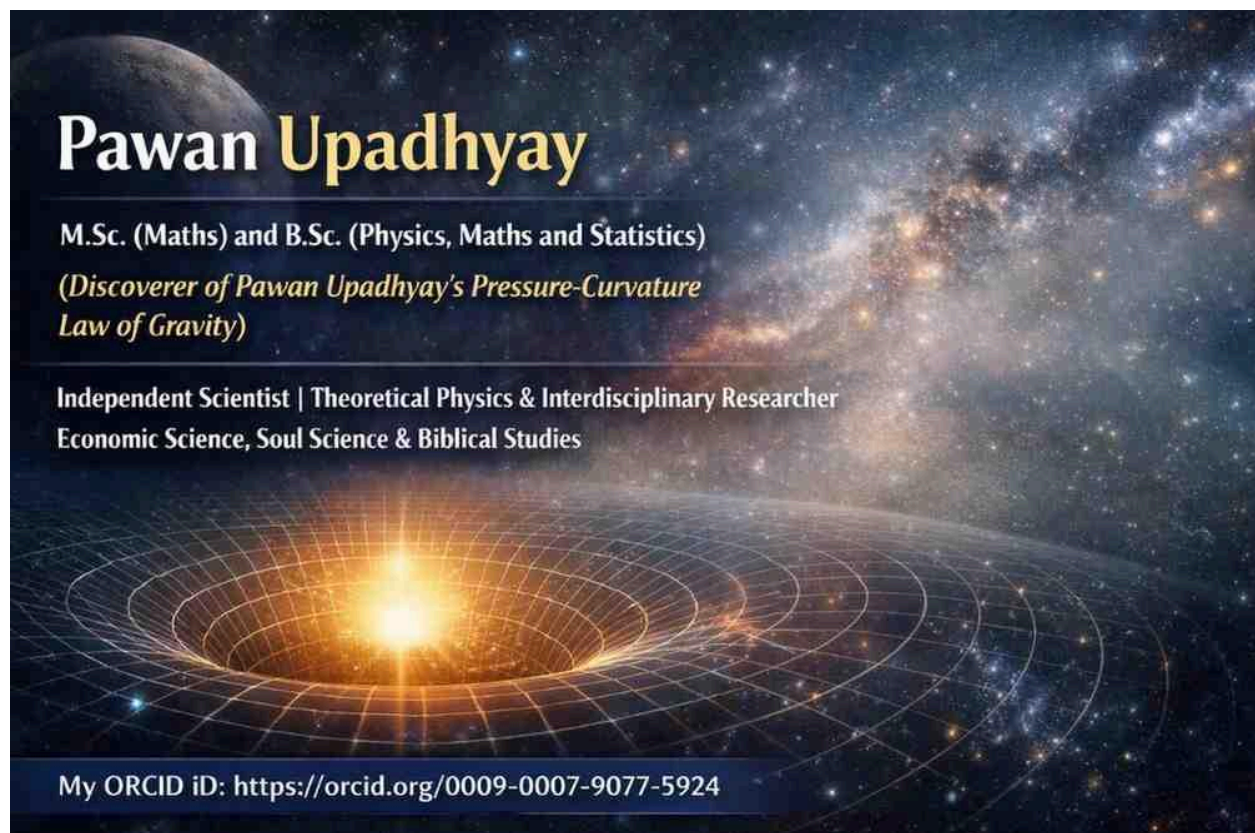
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Abstract

This paper presents a symbolic theological interpretation of **Matthew 10:35–37**. It proposes that the divisions described by Jesus symbolize the spiritual conflict that arises when His holy words confront evil within the human mind and heart. The holy words of Christ awaken holy thoughts that oppose evil thoughts influenced by sin and the powers of darkness. This inner conflict may also be reflected within families when some members embrace Christ while others resist His truth. Thus, the divisions described by Jesus are understood as the consequence of the struggle between holiness and evil, ultimately leading toward spiritual freedom and unity in God.

Keywords

Matthew 10:35–37, Holy Words of Christ, Spiritual Conflict, Holy Thoughts, Evil Thoughts, Symbolic Theology, Family, Spiritual Freedom

1. Introduction

In **Matthew 10:35–37**, Jesus speaks of divisions within families. Rather than interpreting these words as a call to hostility, this study proposes a symbolic reading in which these divisions represent the spiritual conflict produced by the encounter between Christ's holy truth and the forces opposed to God.

2. The Inner Conflict of the Human Mind

The holy words of Jesus Christ create a spiritual confrontation within the human person.

When divine truth enters the mind, holy thoughts arise through God's grace and confront thoughts shaped by sin.

This struggle is an inner battle between:

- holy thoughts that seek God's will;
- evil thoughts that resist holiness;
- truth and deception;
- obedience and rebellion.

The conflict is therefore spiritual before it becomes visible in human relationships.

3. Division Within Families

The symbolic interpretation extends to family relationships.

When members of a family respond differently to the holy words of Christ, disagreement and division may arise. The division is not caused by Christ's desire to separate families but by differing responses to His call.

Where evil influences dominate, resistance to Christ's truth may produce conflict with those who choose to follow Him faithfully.

4. Spiritual Bondage and Spiritual Freedom

This symbolic interpretation understands the holy words of Christ as bringing liberation from the influence of evil.

The holy words expose deception, strengthen faith, and guide the mind toward God's truth. Through this work, Christ frees the human person from spiritual bondage and restores the freedom to love and obey God.

5. True Family Unity

The ultimate purpose of Christ's holy words is not division but reconciliation.

Division occurs only because truth encounters resistance.

When every member of a family accepts Christ's holy words, the family is united in faith, love, forgiveness, and holiness.

Accordingly:

- the holy words of Christ unite families in God's truth;
- sinful and deceptive words create division by turning hearts away from God.

Thus, true and lasting unity is established through fidelity to Christ.

6. Conclusion

Under this symbolic interpretation, Matthew 10:35–37 describes the spiritual conflict that begins within the human mind when Christ's holy words confront sin and falsehood. This inner struggle may become visible within families when individuals respond differently to the Gospel.

The final purpose of Christ's holy words is not permanent division but liberation from evil, renewal of the human mind, and the restoration of families through the truth, love, and peace of God's Kingdom.

Author's Symbolic Thesis

Matthew 10:35–37 symbolically teaches that the holy words of Jesus Christ awaken holy thoughts that confront evil thoughts within the human mind. This spiritual conflict may be reflected within families when individuals respond differently to Christ. Through His

holy words, Christ liberates the human person from the influence of evil and ultimately restores true unity founded upon God's truth, holiness, and love.

[Expanded Research Paper]

Holy Words of Christ and the Inner Spiritual Conflict: A Symbolic Theological Interpretation of Matthew 10:35–37

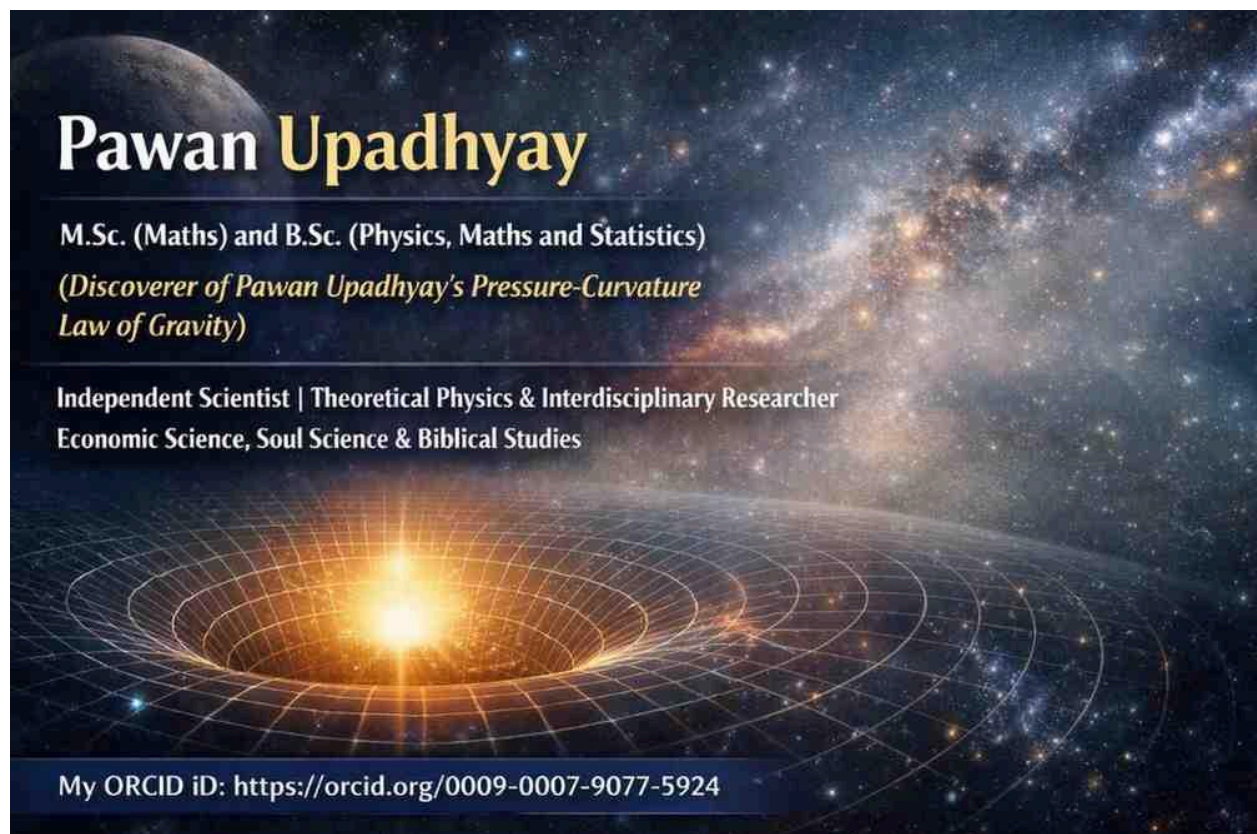
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Abstract

This research paper presents a symbolic theological interpretation of **Matthew 10:35–37**. While the Catholic tradition primarily understands these verses as describing the divisions that arise because some accept Jesus Christ while others reject Him, this study proposes an additional symbolic interpretation. It suggests that the divisions described by Christ also represent the spiritual conflict that begins within the human person when His holy words encounter sin and the influence of evil.

According to this interpretation, the holy words of Jesus Christ awaken holy thoughts that confront evil thoughts rooted in sin. The resulting inner struggle is reflected in the human conscience as a battle between truth and deception, holiness and evil, obedience and rebellion. This symbolic reading further proposes that family divisions may arise when some members receive Christ's holy words while others remain opposed to them. Such divisions are not the purpose of Christ's mission but the consequence of different responses to divine truth.

The paper further proposes that the holy words of Christ bring spiritual liberation. They expose deception, strengthen faith, renew the human mind, and guide believers toward holiness. The ultimate purpose of Christ's mission is therefore not division but reconciliation, healing, and unity in God. Through His holy words, Christ restores individuals and families by establishing true peace founded upon truth, righteousness, and love.

This study is presented as a symbolic theological proposal intended to complement, rather than replace, the historical and literal interpretation of Matthew 10:35–37.

Keywords

Matthew 10:35–37; Holy Words of Christ; Symbolic Theology; Spiritual Conflict; Holy Thoughts; Evil Thoughts; Family Division; Spiritual Liberation; Discipleship; Kingdom of God.

1. Introduction

Matthew 10 records Jesus Christ's instruction to the Twelve Apostles before sending them on their mission. Within this discourse, Jesus prepares His disciples for the opposition they will encounter as they proclaim the Kingdom of God. In **Matthew 10:35–37**, He speaks of divisions within families, emphasizing that fidelity to Him may create conflict even among those bound by the closest human relationships.

The Catholic tradition understands these verses as describing the inevitable consequences of discipleship. Christ does not desire division; rather, division occurs because human beings respond differently to His message. Those who accept Him remain faithful despite opposition, while others reject His teaching. Consequently, the Gospel becomes a point of decision that may separate even members of the same household.

This research proposes an additional symbolic theological interpretation. It suggests that the divisions described by Jesus may also represent the inner spiritual conflict that arises when His holy words confront sin within the human mind and heart. In this symbolic reading, Christ's holy words awaken holy thoughts inspired by divine truth. These holy thoughts oppose evil thoughts that seek to draw the person away from God. The resulting conflict represents the ongoing struggle between holiness and sin that accompanies authentic conversion.

The study further proposes that this inner conflict may become visible within families. When some members respond positively to Christ's holy words while others resist them, disagreement and separation may occur. Such divisions are understood not as Christ's objective but as the consequence of differing responses to God's truth.

Finally, this paper argues that the mission of Christ is fundamentally restorative. His holy words expose deception, free the human mind from the influence of sin, renew the heart through grace, and ultimately establish genuine peace. Therefore, the divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 are temporary manifestations of the struggle between truth and falsehood, whereas the final purpose of Christ's mission is the reconciliation of humanity with God and with one another through holiness, truth, and love.

2. Historical and Literary Context of Matthew 10:35–37

2.1 The Mission Discourse

Matthew 10 forms the second major discourse in the Gospel of Matthew and is commonly known as the **Mission Discourse**. In this chapter, Jesus commissions the Twelve Apostles to proclaim the Kingdom of Heaven, heal the sick, cast out demons, and bear witness to the Gospel. Alongside these instructions, He prepares them for persecution, rejection, and suffering.

Matthew 10:35–37 occurs within this context. Jesus warns His disciples that loyalty to Him may produce opposition, even from those closest to them. His words prepare believers to remain faithful despite the cost of discipleship.

2.2 The Primary Catholic Interpretation

According to Catholic biblical interpretation, Jesus does not encourage conflict within families. Rather, He foretells that His message will inevitably create division because human beings respond differently to God's call.

Some accept Christ with faith, while others reject Him. As a result, households may experience disagreement when family members make different decisions concerning discipleship.

Thus, the division described by Jesus is **the consequence of human freedom in responding to the Gospel**, not the purpose of Christ's mission.

2.3 A Symbolic Theological Reading

This research proposes an additional symbolic interpretation while respecting the primary Catholic understanding.

In this symbolic reading, the family described by Jesus also represents the **interior life of the human person**. Just as members of a household may disagree, different desires, intentions, and thoughts struggle within the human heart and mind.

The holy words of Jesus Christ introduce divine truth into this inner life. As truth enters the conscience, it exposes everything opposed to God's holiness.

Therefore, the division described by Christ may also symbolize the beginning of spiritual transformation.

2.4 The Beginning of the Inner Spiritual Conflict

The encounter with Christ never leaves the human person unchanged.

When the holy words of Christ are received, they awaken:

- holy thoughts that seek God's will;
- love instead of hatred;
- humility instead of pride;
- generosity instead of greed;
- forgiveness instead of revenge;
- faith instead of unbelief.

At the same time, sinful desires resist this transformation.

The result is an interior conflict between the old life shaped by sin and the new life offered by Christ.

Within this symbolic interpretation, the divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 therefore begin within the human person before they become visible in relationships with others.

2.5 The Purpose of Christ's Holy Words

The purpose of Christ's holy words is not destruction but purification.

His teachings expose deception, reveal hidden sin, correct error, and invite every person to repentance.

The holy words of Christ become the beginning of spiritual renewal because they separate truth from falsehood within the conscience.

Consequently, every conflict described in this symbolic interpretation serves the greater purpose of restoring the human person to communion with God.

2.6 Transition to the Symbolic Interpretation

Having established the historical setting and the primary Catholic interpretation, the following chapters will develop the symbolic theological proposal presented in this study.

This proposal does not replace the historical meaning of Matthew 10:35–37. Instead, it explores how the same passage may also illuminate the inner spiritual struggle experienced by believers as the holy words of Jesus Christ confront sin, renew the human mind, and guide humanity toward the peace of God's Kingdom.

3. Methodology: Principles of Symbolic Theological Interpretation

3.1 Purpose of the Methodology

This research employs a **symbolic theological method** to examine Matthew 10:35–37. The purpose of this method is not to replace the historical and literal meaning of Scripture but to explore the deeper spiritual realities that may be expressed through its imagery.

The Catholic tradition recognizes that Sacred Scripture contains multiple senses, including the literal and the spiritual senses. This study is presented as a symbolic theological proposal that builds upon, rather than replaces, the primary meaning of the biblical text.

3.2 The Symbolism of the Holy Words of Christ

Within this study, the holy words of Jesus Christ are understood as the active expression of God's truth.

They do not merely communicate information. They transform the human person by:

- revealing truth;
- exposing sin;
- calling the sinner to repentance;
- strengthening faith;
- guiding the believer toward holiness.

The holy words of Christ therefore possess spiritual power that brings renewal to the human mind and heart.

3.3 The Human Mind as the First Place of Spiritual Conflict

This symbolic interpretation proposes that the first conflict described by Christ begins within the human person.

When divine truth is received, holy thoughts inspired by God's grace confront sinful thoughts that oppose His will.

This inner struggle involves the continual choice between:

- truth and deception;
- humility and pride;
- love and selfishness;
- obedience and rebellion;
- faith and unbelief.

The divisions described by Christ are therefore understood as beginning within the conscience before they may appear in outward relationships.

3.4 Family as a Symbol of Human Relationships

The family in Matthew 10:35–37 is understood first in its literal sense as the household.

This study additionally proposes that family relationships may symbolically represent the wider network of human relationships that are affected by a person's response to Christ.

When individuals accept the holy words of Jesus while others reject them, disagreement may arise. Such division is not produced by hatred but by different responses to divine truth.

Thus, the symbolic interpretation preserves the literal meaning while exploring its spiritual significance.

3.5 Spiritual Liberation Through Christ

The holy words of Christ are presented in this study as words of liberation.

They free the human person from deception, restore the conscience, and direct the believer toward God's righteousness.

Their purpose is not condemnation but transformation.

Every command, teaching, miracle, and act of mercy performed by Jesus reveals God's desire to restore humanity through truth and holiness.

3.6 The Goal of the Symbolic Interpretation

The ultimate purpose of this symbolic interpretation is to demonstrate that Christ's words are directed toward the renewal of the whole person.

The divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 are understood as temporary manifestations of the struggle between holiness and sin.

The final goal of Christ's mission is reconciliation with God, renewal of the human heart, and the establishment of true peace founded upon divine truth, justice, mercy, and love.

3.7 Foundation for the Following Chapters

The following chapters will apply this symbolic methodology to Matthew 10:35–37 by examining the conflict between holy thoughts and sinful thoughts, the transformation of the human mind through Christ's holy words, and the restoration of unity through faithful discipleship.

Accordingly, this research seeks to show that the holy words of Jesus Christ initiate a process of spiritual renewal that leads the believer from inner conflict to freedom, from deception to truth, and from division to communion with God.

4. The Holy Words of Christ and the Inner Battle of the Human Mind

4.1 The Beginning of the Spiritual Battle

Within this symbolic theological interpretation, the words of Jesus Christ do more than instruct the human intellect. They enter the conscience, illuminate the heart, and begin a spiritual conflict between holiness and sin.

The holy words of Christ awaken holy thoughts that seek truth, righteousness, mercy, humility, and obedience to God. At the same time, sinful desires resist this transformation. Thus, the first battle described by Matthew 10:35–37 is understood as an interior conflict within the human person.

This conflict is not evidence of Christ's failure to bring peace. Rather, it is the necessary beginning of spiritual renewal.

4.2 Holy Thoughts and Sinful Thoughts

Every person experiences a struggle between thoughts that lead toward God and thoughts that lead away from Him.

Within this symbolic interpretation:

- Holy thoughts encourage faith, hope, love, mercy, forgiveness, humility, and obedience.
- Sinful thoughts encourage pride, hatred, greed, selfishness, envy, deception, and rebellion against God's will.

The holy words of Christ expose these sinful thoughts and call the believer to reject them through repentance and faithful discipleship.

4.3 The Influence of Evil

Sacred Scripture teaches that evil seeks to deceive humanity and draw people away from God.

In this symbolic interpretation, evil seeks to influence the human mind by encouraging thoughts that oppose God's truth. These influences become visible wherever deception, hatred, greed, selfishness, and sin are allowed to govern human choices.

The holy words of Christ confront these influences with divine truth. They expose deception, strengthen the conscience, and direct the believer toward holiness.

Thus, the spiritual battle is fought not with physical weapons but through the acceptance of Christ's truth.

4.4 The Healing Power of Christ's Holy Words

Throughout the Gospels, Jesus healed the sick, forgave sins, restored the broken, and proclaimed the Kingdom of God.

Within this symbolic interpretation, these acts reveal that His holy words possess healing power.

The holy words of Christ heal not only the body but also the inner life of the human person.

They:

- heal wounded hearts;
- restore hope;
- strengthen faith;
- overcome deception;
- free the conscience from the bondage of sin;
- lead believers toward holiness.

Therefore, the healing ministry of Christ demonstrates the renewing power of His holy words.

4.5 The Conflict Leads to Freedom

The inner conflict awakened by Christ is not intended to leave the believer in continual struggle.

Its purpose is transformation.

As the believer embraces Christ's holy words, sinful thoughts lose their influence, and the mind is gradually renewed by divine truth.

The conflict therefore becomes the pathway to spiritual freedom.

The peace that follows is not the false peace created by compromise with sin but the true peace that comes from reconciliation with God.

4.6 Summary

According to this symbolic interpretation, Matthew 10:35–37 describes the beginning of an inner spiritual battle initiated by the holy words of Jesus Christ. His holy words awaken holy thoughts that confront sinful thoughts, expose deception, heal the wounded heart, and renew the human mind.

The division spoken of by Christ is therefore understood as the necessary conflict between holiness and sin that precedes spiritual transformation. Through perseverance in His truth, the believer is led from inner division to genuine peace, freedom, and communion with God.

5. Holy Thoughts versus Evil Thoughts: The Spiritual Conflict within the Human Mind

5.1 The Human Mind as the Battlefield

Within this symbolic theological interpretation of Matthew 10:35–37, the human mind is understood as the primary battlefield of spiritual conflict.

When the holy words of Jesus Christ are received, they illuminate the conscience and awaken holy thoughts that seek communion with God. These holy thoughts confront evil thoughts that encourage sin and separation from God.

The division described by Christ therefore begins within the inner life of the human person before it may become visible in external relationships.

5.2 The Nature of Holy Thoughts

Holy thoughts originate from openness to God's grace and truth. They lead the believer toward a life that reflects the character of Jesus Christ.

Holy thoughts inspire:

- faith in God;
- love for God and neighbor;
- humility;
- mercy;
- forgiveness;
- purity of heart;
- justice;
- compassion;
- obedience to God's will;
- hope in eternal life.

As these thoughts grow through prayer, Scripture, and faithful discipleship, they shape both the mind and the actions of the believer.

5.3 The Nature of Evil Thoughts

Evil thoughts seek to turn the human heart away from God. They distort truth, weaken faith, and encourage attitudes and actions contrary to holiness.

Such thoughts may include:

- pride;
- greed;
- selfish ambition;
- hatred;
- envy;
- revenge;
- deceit;
- despair;
- unbelief;
- resistance to God's truth.

Within this symbolic interpretation, these thoughts represent the spiritual opposition encountered by every disciple seeking to follow Christ faithfully.

5.4 The Holy Words of Christ as the Standard of Truth

The holy words of Jesus Christ reveal the difference between holy thoughts and evil thoughts.

His teachings expose deception, correct false understanding, and invite every person to repentance.

As the believer receives His words with faith, the conscience is gradually renewed, enabling the individual to discern truth from falsehood and holiness from sin.

Thus, Christ's words become the measure by which every thought is examined.

5.5 Spiritual Renewal of the Mind

The conflict between holy thoughts and evil thoughts is not intended to remain unresolved.

The purpose of Christ's mission is the renewal of the human mind through God's grace.

As believers continue to hear, believe, and obey the holy words of Christ:

- holy thoughts become stronger;
- sinful habits are challenged;
- virtue replaces vice;
- truth overcomes deception;
- love overcomes selfishness.

This transformation reflects the ongoing work of God's grace in the life of the disciple.

5.6 The Goal of the Spiritual Conflict

The spiritual conflict described in this symbolic interpretation has a positive purpose.

Christ does not awaken conflict merely to expose evil but to overcome it.

The holy words of Christ are given so that the believer may experience:

- freedom from the power of sin;
- growth in holiness;
- renewal of the mind;
- deeper communion with God;
- true peace founded upon divine truth.

The ultimate victory belongs not to evil thoughts but to the transforming power of Christ's truth.

5.7 Conclusion

According to this symbolic theological interpretation, Matthew 10:35–37 reveals an inner conflict between holy thoughts awakened by Christ and evil thoughts that oppose God's will. This struggle is part of the believer's journey toward holiness.

The holy words of Jesus Christ continually purify the mind, strengthen the conscience, and lead the faithful from spiritual conflict into the peace, freedom, and unity found in the Kingdom of God.

6. Family Division as a Reflection of Spiritual Conflict

6.1 Introduction

Matthew 10:35–37 describes division within the closest human relationships. Jesus speaks of conflict between family members, not because He desires hatred or broken families, but because the acceptance or rejection of His holy words may produce different responses within the same household.

This research proposes an additional symbolic theological interpretation. Alongside the literal meaning, family division is understood as a reflection of the deeper spiritual conflict between God's truth and the resistance of sin.

6.2 The Family and Human Freedom

The family is the first community in which faith, love, and obedience are learned. Every member possesses the freedom to respond to Christ's call.

When some members receive the holy words of Jesus Christ while others reject them, disagreement may arise. The division is therefore the consequence of different responses to divine truth rather than the purpose of Christ's mission.

6.3 The Influence of Evil upon Human Relationships

Within this symbolic interpretation, sin and deception seek to weaken the unity that God intends for families.

Whenever pride, greed, selfishness, hatred, jealousy, or unforgiveness govern human relationships, peace is replaced by conflict.

These attitudes oppose the holy words of Christ, which call every person to forgiveness, humility, mercy, and faithful love.

Thus, division within families reflects the broader spiritual struggle between holiness and sin.

6.4 The Holy Words of Christ Restore Relationships

The holy words of Jesus Christ possess the power to restore what has been broken by sin.

His teachings call family members to:

- forgive one another;
- love one another;
- seek reconciliation;
- practice humility;
- serve one another with compassion;
- remain faithful to God above every earthly attachment.

As these virtues grow, families are strengthened through God's grace.

6.5 True Unity Is Founded upon Christ

According to this symbolic interpretation, lasting family unity is not established merely through shared blood or common interests.

True unity is established when family members allow the holy words of Christ to shape their thoughts, words, and actions.

Such unity is founded upon:

- truth rather than deception;
- love rather than selfishness;
- forgiveness rather than resentment;
- holiness rather than sin.

Where Christ's truth is embraced, genuine peace becomes possible.

6.6 The Goal of Christ's Mission

The temporary divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 should not be understood as the final purpose of Christ's mission.

Jesus came to reconcile humanity with God and to restore human relationships through divine love.

The conflict described in this passage represents the painful reality that not everyone responds to God's invitation in the same way.

Nevertheless, Christ continually calls every person toward repentance, reconciliation, and communion with God.

6.7 Conclusion

Within this symbolic theological interpretation, family division reflects the spiritual conflict that arises when Christ's holy words confront sin and call people to conversion.

Although division may occur because individuals respond differently to the Gospel, the ultimate purpose of Christ's mission is not separation but restoration.

His holy words renew the human heart, heal broken relationships, and establish families upon the enduring foundation of truth, holiness, mercy, and love.

7. The Holy Words of Christ as Spiritual Liberation

7.1 Introduction

Within this symbolic theological interpretation, the holy words of Jesus Christ are understood as words of liberation. They do not merely convey divine teaching; they actively call the human person from the bondage of sin into the freedom of God's Kingdom.

Matthew 10:35–37 therefore represents not only the conflict that arises through discipleship but also the beginning of spiritual liberation. The divisions described by Jesus are temporary signs of the struggle between truth and falsehood, leading ultimately to freedom in Christ.

7.2 The Liberating Power of Christ's Holy Words

Throughout the Gospel, Jesus speaks words that restore life, forgive sins, strengthen faith, and reveal the mercy of God.

Within this symbolic interpretation, His holy words:

- awaken the conscience;
- reveal hidden sin;
- expose deception;
- encourage repentance;
- strengthen faith;
- guide believers toward holiness.

The words of Christ therefore possess liberating power because they invite every person to live according to God's truth.

7.3 Liberation from the Bondage of Sin

Sin enslaves the human heart by separating it from God.

The holy words of Christ call the believer to reject:

- pride;
- greed;
- selfishness;
- hatred;
- deception;
- unbelief;
- every attitude that opposes God's will.

As these sinful patterns are abandoned through God's grace, the believer experiences increasing freedom to love God and neighbor.

Thus, liberation begins with the transformation of the heart.

7.4 Renewal of the Human Mind

The symbolic interpretation proposed in this study emphasizes that Christ's holy words renew the mind.

As believers continually receive His teaching:

- truth replaces deception;
- hope replaces despair;
- humility replaces pride;
- generosity replaces greed;
- forgiveness replaces resentment;
- love replaces hatred.

The renewal of the mind produces a renewed way of living that reflects the character of Jesus Christ.

7.5 Liberation Leads to True Peace

The conflict described in Matthew 10:35–37 is not the final destination of the believer.

Its purpose is to remove the obstacles that prevent true peace with God.

When the holy words of Christ are embraced, the believer experiences a peace founded upon:

- truth;
- righteousness;
- holiness;
- mercy;
- faithful obedience to God.

This peace differs from a false peace that ignores sin or compromises with evil.

7.6 The Mission of Christ

The mission of Jesus Christ is fundamentally restorative.

He came to proclaim the Kingdom of God, forgive sins, heal the broken, and reconcile humanity with the Father.

Within this symbolic interpretation, every conflict initiated by His holy words serves the greater purpose of spiritual restoration.

The goal is not permanent division but renewed life in communion with God.

7.7 Conclusion

According to this symbolic theological interpretation, the holy words of Jesus Christ bring spiritual liberation by exposing sin, renewing the mind, strengthening faith, and guiding believers toward holiness.

The divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 are therefore understood as temporary manifestations of the struggle between truth and falsehood.

The final purpose of Christ's mission is freedom from sin and the establishment of true peace through reconciliation with God.

8. The Restoration of Family Unity Through Christ

8.1 Introduction

Matthew 10:35–37 describes division within families as a consequence of different responses to Jesus Christ. However, this symbolic theological interpretation proposes that such division is not the final purpose of Christ's mission. Rather, it is a temporary stage in the process of spiritual renewal that ultimately leads to reconciliation through God's grace.

The holy words of Christ first expose what is opposed to God. Only after truth is revealed can genuine healing and lasting unity be established.

8.2 Christ Is the Source of True Unity

Jesus Christ did not come to destroy families but to restore humanity's relationship with God.

Within this symbolic interpretation, the holy words of Christ remove the spiritual obstacles that prevent authentic unity. Pride, hatred, greed, selfishness, deception, and unforgiveness divide human relationships. Christ's teachings call believers to reject these attitudes and embrace the virtues of the Kingdom of God.

True unity is therefore founded upon truth, holiness, mercy, justice, and love.

8.3 The Transformation of the Human Heart

Every lasting reconciliation begins with the transformation of the individual heart.

The holy words of Christ call each person to examine his or her own life through repentance and faith. As the heart is renewed by God's grace, relationships are also transformed.

This symbolic interpretation understands spiritual renewal as a movement from:

- hatred to love;
- pride to humility;
- greed to generosity;
- selfishness to self-giving love;
- resentment to forgiveness;
- deception to truth.

These transformations become the foundation for restored family relationships.

8.4 Families Built upon Christ

A family founded upon the holy words of Christ is strengthened by faith and mutual love.

Such a family seeks:

- faithfulness to God;
- prayer together;
- forgiveness after conflict;
- compassion toward one another;
- justice within relationships;
- service inspired by Christ's example.

When these virtues guide family life, unity becomes a reflection of God's Kingdom.

8.5 Peace Through Holiness

The peace established by Christ differs from peace based merely upon the absence of conflict.

Within this symbolic interpretation, true peace is the fruit of holiness.

It is a peace created when:

- truth replaces deception;
- righteousness replaces injustice;
- mercy replaces revenge;
- love overcomes selfishness;
- faith overcomes fear.

Such peace remains stable because it is rooted in God's truth rather than in human compromise.

8.6 The Final Goal of Christ's Mission

The divisions spoken of in Matthew 10:35–37 are temporary realities within the journey of discipleship.

The final goal of Christ's mission is the restoration of communion between God and humanity and, through that communion, the restoration of authentic human relationships.

Accordingly, every conflict produced by the encounter with Christ's holy words serves the greater purpose of revealing truth, inviting repentance, and leading believers toward reconciliation.

8.7 Conclusion

Within this symbolic theological interpretation, the holy words of Jesus Christ ultimately unite rather than divide.

They first expose sin, reveal truth, and call the human person to conversion. Through God's grace, this process renews the heart, heals broken relationships, and establishes genuine unity founded upon holiness, truth, mercy, and love.

Thus, the temporary divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 become the beginning of God's work of reconciliation, culminating in the peace of His Kingdom.

9. Biblical Parallels Supporting the Symbolic Interpretation

9.1 Introduction

The symbolic interpretation presented in this study is strengthened by examining other passages of Sacred Scripture in which the holy words of God transform the human person. Although these passages do not directly interpret Matthew 10:35–37, they illustrate the recurring biblical theme that God's word reveals truth, exposes sin, renews the mind, and leads believers toward holiness.

9.2 The Word of God Reveals the Human Heart

Throughout Scripture, the Word of God uncovers what is hidden within the human heart.

When Jesus taught the crowds, many experienced repentance, while others rejected His message. The same holy words produced different responses because each person freely responded to God's truth.

Within this symbolic interpretation, this pattern reflects the inner conflict described in Matthew 10:35–37. Divine truth exposes both holy desires and sinful inclinations, inviting every person to choose the path of holiness.

9.3 The Ministry of Healing

The Gospels repeatedly show Jesus healing the sick, restoring those who suffered, forgiving sins, and freeing people from the power of evil.

These works reveal that His holy words are life-giving.

Within this symbolic interpretation, every act of healing signifies more than physical restoration. It also represents the renewal of the human heart through the power of divine truth.

The holy words of Christ restore faith, strengthen hope, and reveal God's mercy.

9.4 Temptation and Victory Through God's Truth

The earthly ministry of Jesus demonstrates that truth overcomes temptation.

When confronted with evil, Jesus responded faithfully to the will of the Father.

Within this symbolic interpretation, Christ's example teaches believers that victory over temptation is found through steadfast obedience to God's truth.

The holy words of Christ therefore become the believer's guide in every spiritual struggle.

9.5 The Renewal of the Human Mind

Sacred Scripture consistently calls believers to reject sinful patterns of thinking and to seek renewal through God's grace.

Within this symbolic interpretation, the holy words of Christ transform the human mind by replacing:

- deception with truth;
- fear with faith;
- pride with humility;
- selfishness with love;
- hatred with mercy.

The renewal of the mind becomes the foundation for a renewed life.

9.6 Peace Established Through Truth

The peace offered by Christ is inseparable from truth and holiness.

False peace tolerates injustice and ignores sin.

True peace is established when human beings are reconciled with God and live according to His will.

Within this symbolic interpretation, the temporary divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 serve this greater purpose by exposing what prevents authentic peace.

9.7 The Kingdom of God

The proclamation of the Kingdom of God is the central theme of Christ's ministry.

Every miracle, teaching, and act of mercy points toward the restoration of God's reign within the human heart.

Within this symbolic interpretation, the holy words of Christ prepare believers to become faithful citizens of God's Kingdom by transforming their thoughts, renewing their hearts, and guiding them toward lives of holiness.

9.8 Conclusion

The broader witness of Sacred Scripture consistently presents God's word as living, transformative, and life-giving.

These biblical themes support the symbolic theological proposal advanced in this study. The holy words of Jesus Christ reveal truth, expose sin, renew the human mind, restore the human heart, and ultimately establish the true peace of God's Kingdom.

Accordingly, the divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 are understood not as Christ's final purpose but as part of the spiritual transformation through which God prepares His people for eternal communion with Him.

10. Theological Implications of the Symbolic Interpretation

10.1 Introduction

The symbolic theological interpretation presented in this study seeks to deepen reflection on Matthew 10:35–37 by exploring the spiritual dimensions of Christ's words. While preserving the primary Catholic understanding of the passage, this interpretation considers how the divisions described by Jesus may also symbolize the inner transformation that occurs when the human person encounters the living Word of God.

The following theological implications arise from this symbolic reading.

10.2 Christ's Holy Words as the Beginning of Spiritual Transformation

The holy words of Jesus Christ are understood as the beginning of spiritual transformation.

They awaken the conscience, reveal hidden sin, and invite every person to repentance. Before genuine peace can be established, the false peace created by sin must be confronted by divine truth.

Thus, the conflict described in Matthew 10:35–37 becomes the first stage of spiritual renewal.

10.3 The Human Heart as the Place of Decision

Every disciple must decide whether to accept or reject the holy words of Christ.

Within this symbolic interpretation, the human heart becomes the place where this decision is made.

The conflict between holiness and sin is therefore not merely external but deeply personal. Every act of faith strengthens communion with God, while every rejection of divine truth strengthens the influence of sin.

10.4 Family Relationships and Discipleship

The symbolic interpretation emphasizes that family relationships are profoundly affected by a person's response to Christ.

Where the Gospel is received, families are invited toward forgiveness, humility, service, and love.

Where Christ's message is resisted, conflict may arise because members respond differently to His call.

Nevertheless, Christ's purpose remains reconciliation rather than permanent separation.

10.5 The Mission of the Church

The Church continues the mission entrusted by Jesus Christ.

Through the proclamation of the Gospel, the celebration of the sacraments, works of charity, and faithful witness, the Church proclaims the same holy truth that calls humanity to conversion.

Within this symbolic interpretation, the Church participates in Christ's work by inviting every person from sin toward holiness and from division toward unity in God.

10.6 The Kingdom of God and True Peace

The peace proclaimed by Christ is not merely the absence of disagreement.

It is the peace that results from reconciliation with God.

This symbolic interpretation understands the Kingdom of God as the restoration of human life under God's loving rule.

As Christ's holy words transform minds and hearts, believers become instruments of truth, justice, mercy, and peace within their families and communities.

10.7 Hope for Humanity

The symbolic interpretation concludes with hope.

Although conflict accompanies the encounter with divine truth, conflict is never the final goal.

The holy words of Christ continually invite humanity toward repentance, forgiveness, healing, and reconciliation.

Therefore, every struggle experienced by the faithful becomes an opportunity for spiritual growth through God's grace.

10.8 Conclusion

The theological implications of this symbolic interpretation affirm that Matthew 10:35–37 speaks not only about the cost of discipleship but also about the transforming power of Christ's holy words.

The divisions described by Jesus become signs of the spiritual struggle between truth and sin. Through faithful perseverance, believers are led beyond conflict into the lasting peace established by God.

Accordingly, this symbolic interpretation presents Christ's holy words as instruments of spiritual renewal, guiding humanity from inner conflict to holiness, from deception to truth, and from division to communion with God.

11. Conclusion and Author's Symbolic Thesis

11.1 Conclusion

Matthew 10:35–37 has traditionally been understood within Catholic biblical interpretation as describing the division that may arise when people respond differently to Jesus Christ and His Gospel. This historical and literal meaning remains the primary interpretation of the passage.

This research has proposed an additional symbolic theological interpretation. It suggests that the divisions described by Jesus may also represent the spiritual conflict that begins within the human mind and heart when His holy words encounter sin. The holy words of Christ awaken holy thoughts that confront sinful thoughts, leading the believer through repentance toward spiritual renewal.

Within this symbolic interpretation, the divisions that may appear within families are understood as reflections of differing responses to Christ's call. Some embrace His holy words and seek the Kingdom of God, while others resist His truth. The resulting conflict is therefore not the purpose of Christ's mission but the consequence of human freedom in responding to divine grace.

This study has further argued that the holy words of Christ possess transforming power. They reveal truth, expose deception, strengthen faith, renew the conscience, heal the wounded heart, and guide believers toward holiness. Their purpose is not destruction but restoration.

The ultimate mission of Jesus Christ is reconciliation. Through His holy words and His saving work, He restores humanity to communion with God and calls families, communities, and nations to live according to truth, justice, mercy, and love.

Accordingly, the temporary divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 become part of the believer's journey from spiritual conflict to spiritual peace. The final goal is not division but unity in God, established through faithful discipleship and the transforming power of Christ's truth.

11.2 Author's Symbolic Thesis

The author proposes the following symbolic theological interpretation of **Matthew 10:35–37**:

The holy words of Jesus Christ awaken holy thoughts that confront sinful thoughts within the human mind and heart. This spiritual conflict represents the beginning of conversion, as divine truth exposes deception and calls the believer to repentance.

When individuals within a family respond differently to Christ's holy words, visible divisions may arise. These divisions are not created by Christ's desire to separate families but by differing responses to God's truth.

The holy words of Christ ultimately restore what sin has wounded. They renew the conscience, strengthen faith, heal the heart, and establish true peace founded upon holiness, truth, mercy, justice, and love.

Therefore, the divisions described in Matthew 10:35–37 are understood symbolically as the temporary struggle between holiness and sin that precedes spiritual renewal, reconciliation, and lasting communion with God.

11.3 Final Statement

This symbolic theological interpretation is offered as the author's original scholarly proposal. It is intended to complement the historical and literal interpretation of Matthew 10:35–37 by exploring the spiritual significance of Christ's holy words in the life of the believer. The study affirms that the ultimate purpose of Jesus Christ is not division but the restoration of humanity through the truth, grace, and peace of the Kingdom of God.

[2nd Research Paper]

God the Holy Spiritual Father and Jesus Christ the Holy Spiritual Master: A Symbolic Theological Reflection on the Primacy of Divine Guidance

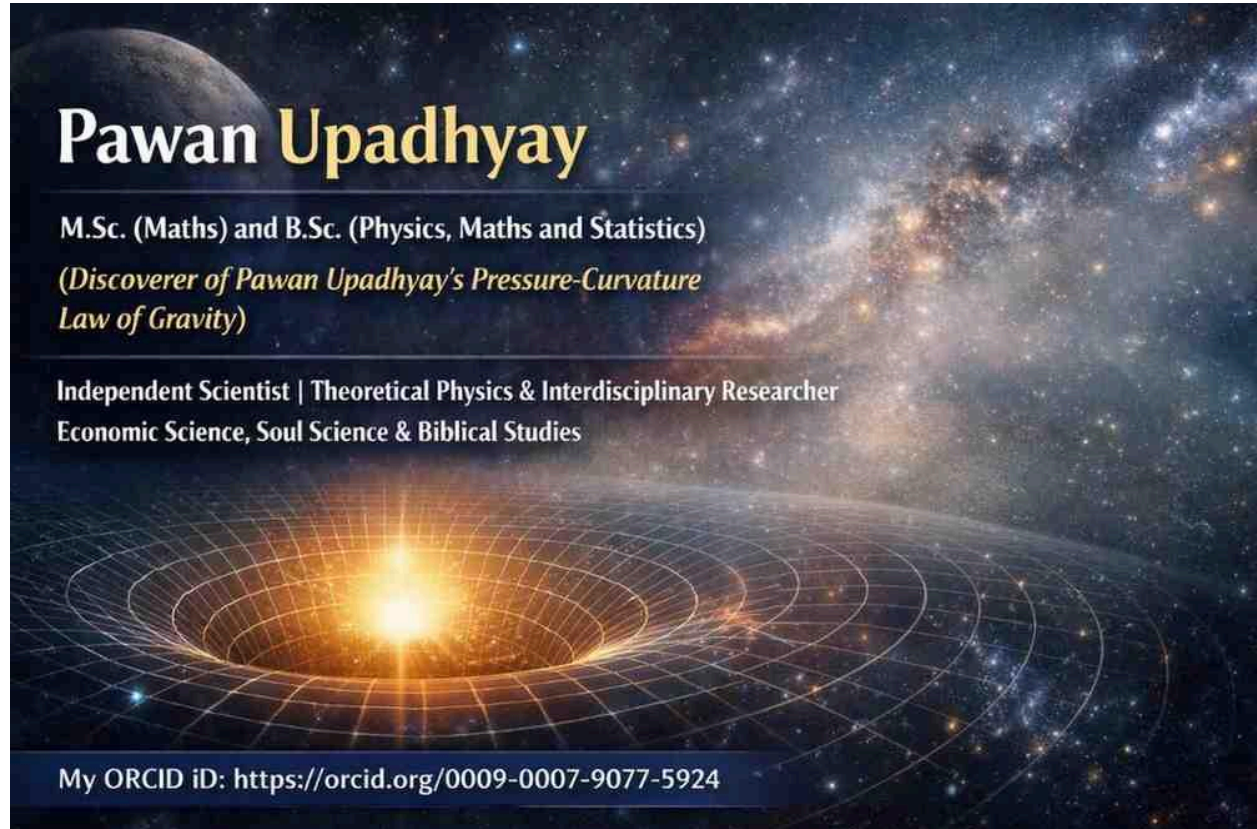
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Abstract

This paper presents a symbolic theological reflection on the primacy of God's guidance in human life. It proposes that God is the Holy Spiritual Father of humanity and that Jesus Christ is the Holy Spiritual Master whose holy words continually guide believers toward holy virtuous actions and holiness. Human parents are a gift from God and deserve honor, yet they remain imperfect and capable of error. Consequently, when human guidance conflicts with the will of God, believers are called to place God first. This study argues that the holy words of Christ lead humanity toward truth, righteousness, and eternal life, while sinful guidance can draw people away from God's Kingdom.

Keywords

God the Father; Jesus Christ; Spiritual Father; Spiritual Master; Holiness; Virtue; Discipleship; Symbolic Theology; Divine Guidance

1. Introduction

Christian faith teaches that God is the Creator and Father of all who belong to Him. Jesus Christ, the Son of God, reveals the Father's will and calls humanity into a life of holiness through His teachings, His example, and His saving work.

This paper proposes a symbolic theological reflection in which God is understood as the Holy Spiritual Father and Jesus Christ as the Holy Spiritual Master. Through His holy words and holy life, Christ continually directs believers toward virtue, holiness, and faithful obedience to God.

2. God as the Holy Spiritual Father

God is the source of truth, justice, mercy, and holiness.

As the Holy Spiritual Father, He desires the salvation and sanctification of His children. His commandments are given not to restrict humanity but to lead people into freedom through righteousness and love.

The Father's guidance is perfect because it proceeds from His perfect goodness.

3. Jesus Christ as the Holy Spiritual Master

Jesus Christ perfectly reveals the Father.

His holy words teach:

- love of God;
- love of neighbor;
- humility;
- mercy;
- forgiveness;
- justice;
- holiness;
- faithful obedience to the will of the Father.

Every teaching and every action of Christ directs believers toward holy virtuous actions that reflect the character of God.

4. Human Imperfection and the Need for Divine Guidance

Human beings, including parents, teachers, and leaders, are imperfect and capable of moral failure.

When parents live virtuous lives, they can become powerful examples of faithfulness.

However, when a parent embraces corruption, dishonesty, violence, or other sinful ways, that parent may influence children toward similar patterns of behavior.

For this reason, the believer's highest loyalty belongs to God.

The holy words of Christ remain the ultimate standard by which every human teaching and example should be judged.

5. The Primacy of God

Christian discipleship requires that God be placed above every earthly relationship.

Love and respect for parents remain important moral responsibilities. Nevertheless, when human guidance contradicts God's will, believers are called to remain faithful to God.

The holy words of Jesus Christ guide believers toward:

- holy virtuous actions;
- holiness of life;
- truth;
- righteousness;
- mercy;
- eternal communion with God.

6. Spiritual Formation Through Christ

The holy words of Christ continually transform the believer.

They:

- renew the mind;
- strengthen the conscience;
- expose sin;
- encourage repentance;
- cultivate virtue;
- prepare believers for the Kingdom of God.

Through faithful discipleship, the believer increasingly reflects the holiness of the Holy Spiritual Father.

7. Conclusion

This symbolic theological reflection proposes that God is the Holy Spiritual Father and Jesus Christ is the Holy Spiritual Master whose holy words lead humanity toward holiness and virtuous living.

Although human parents deserve honor and respect, they remain imperfect. Therefore, believers should always place God first and evaluate every human influence according to the truth revealed by Jesus Christ.

By following Christ's holy words, believers are guided away from sin and toward a life of holiness, righteousness, and everlasting communion with God.

Author's Symbolic Thesis

God is the Holy Spiritual Father, and Jesus Christ is the Holy Spiritual Master. The holy words of Christ continually guide believers toward holy virtuous actions and holiness. Because human beings are imperfect, every human influence must be measured against God's truth. Therefore, believers are called to place God first, following Christ as the perfect guide to holiness and eternal life.